

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1209

By Harris

A RESOLUTION to honor and recognize PENCIL.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly take great pleasure in paying tribute to Public Education Needs Community Involvement and Leadership (PENCIL), an organization committed to helping young people achieve academic success and prepare for life; and

WHEREAS, PENCIL is a nonprofit organization in Nashville that links Metro Nashville Public Schools (MNPS) with community resources to better serve the needs of both students and educators; and

WHEREAS, for forty-four years, PENCIL has worked with private industry, city officials, and other nonprofits to achieve strategic goals for MNPS students through community partnerships; and

WHEREAS, PENCIL and its network of partners are committed to meeting the growing needs of MNPS, serving more than 79,000 students across 159 schools, and ensuring equal access to education for all students; and

WHEREAS, PENCIL Partners match the specific needs of each school with an appropriate business, community group, or individual, supporting more than 600 local organizations as active partners in MNPS schools; and

WHEREAS, PENCIL works closely with MNPS leadership to develop programs and services essential for student success, filling resource gaps and addressing immediate and ongoing needs; and

WHEREAS, PENCIL offers programs, including the DG PENCIL Box, a free educator resource center where educators shop each month for in-demand supplies, such as backpacks, pencils, crayons, filler paper, and more; PENCIL's STEAM Lending Library, which provides hands-on, essential resources that empower students to meet state computer science

standards and prepare for success in a technology-driven world; and Accelerating Scholars, which delivers high impact, low ratio tutoring to MNPS students in grades kindergarten through five; and

WHEREAS, PENCIL is currently under the astute guidance of President and Chief Executive Officer Christiane Buggs, whose passion has allowed her to lead PENCIL to unprecedented heights in recent years; and

WHEREAS, in January 2025, PENCIL received an anonymous donation of more than two million pencils—enough to provide MNPS students and educators for years; with the necessary supplies, teachers are ready to teach, and students are equipped to learn and succeed; and

WHEREAS, from 2024 to 2025, PENCIL achieved more than \$5.93 million in total community investment for MNPS schools through business partnerships and volunteer service, an amount that includes nearly \$3 million in free resources distributed to educators, more than 33,000 volunteer hours, and more than \$1 million in grants to and for MNPS; and

WHEREAS, PENCIL continues to support MNPS by recruiting business partners and serving as a teacher resource center, ensuring that each student has equitable access to resources and opportunities; and

WHEREAS, Public Education Needs Community Involvement and Leadership is wholly dedicated to serving the needs of our youth and our educators through community partnerships and is deserving of our praise and approbation; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that, on March 30, 2026, National Pencil Day, we honor and recognize the staff and volunteers of Public Education Needs Community Involvement and Leadership (PENCIL) and its community partners and supporters for their many generous and compassionate

contributions to the Nashville community and wish them every continued success in their future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.